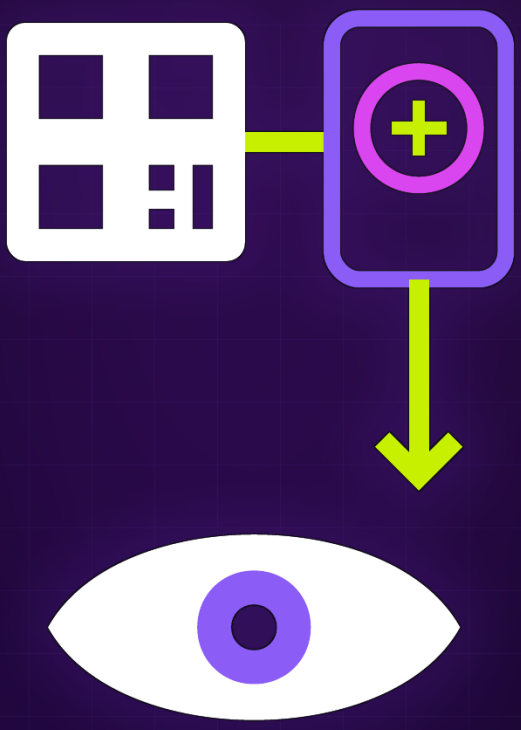
UAT-11985 GOOGLE AITM

Hunts five source-published hostnames in email and QR-code-extracted URLs.

HUNTING QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



REPORT DATE
09 October 2026

STATUS
Untested implementation sketch

PRIMARY PLATFORM
Microsoft Defender XDR

OPERATIONAL VALUE
7.0 / 10

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision, confidence and evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

7.0

Hunts five source-published hostnames in email and QR-code-extracted URLs.

CLASSIFICATION

Hunting query

Medium confidence. Source-supported campaign evidence; environmental prevalence is not validated.

1 primary table
1 primary query
0 production claims
4 validation gates

Evidence boundary

A URL match does not prove delivery, QR scanning, credential capture, MFA bypass, or account compromise.

BEHAVIOR AND EVIDENCE

Observed facts separated from analytical scope.

MECHANICS

#	Source-supported fact
1	Cisco Talos reported a spearphishing campaign targeting Taiwan-based research organizations.
2	The actor hid destinations behind benign-looking links and modified QR codes in event posters.
3	The published hostnames support retrospective campaign scoping only.

Detection hypothesis

If the published behavior occurs in a covered endpoint or cloud workload, EmailUrlInfo should retain the campaign-specific evidence used by this hunt.

Unconfirmed elements

A URL match does not prove delivery, QR scanning, credential capture, MFA bypass, or account compromise.

ATT&CK: T1566.002

TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Collection prerequisites and field reliability.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

EmailUrlInfo

Microsoft Defender XDR advanced hunting coverage must retain the fields referenced by the query.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Identity, device, network, file reputation, prevalence, owner, change record, and adjacent-event context.

Requirement	Decision
Primary platform	Microsoft Defender XDR
Primary table	EmailUrlInfo
Query status	Untested implementation sketch
Classification	Hunting; no alerting before validation

Coverage caveat

An empty result may mean no match, missing telemetry, retention gaps, parser differences, or field sparsity.

PRIMARY KQL

Source-supported conditions with investigable output.

HUNTING

STATUS

Hunting query — Untested implementation sketch

KQL — UNTESTED

```
// UAT-11985 Google AitM infrastructure in email and QR-code URLs
// Platform: Microsoft Defender XDR Advanced Hunting
// Status: Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch
// Confidence: Medium (source-confirmed IOC match; IOC expiry and tenant testing required)
// Prerequisite: Microsoft Defender for Office 365 populating EmailUrlInfo
// Evidence: Cisco Talos, 2026-10-08; IOCs published in Cisco-Talos/IOCs.
// Interpretation: A result is an IOC association, not proof of credential theft,
// MFA bypass, account takeover, campaign attribution, or successful delivery.
let UAT11985Domains = dynamic([
    "google.morelessty.com",
    "jmlh.morelessty.com",
    "google.centerhoti.com",
    "google.natrlyi.com",
    "accounts.natrlyi.com"
]);
EmailUrlInfo
| where UrlDomain in~ (UAT11985Domains)
| project Timestamp, NetworkMessageId, Url, UrlDomain, UrlLocation,
          UrlChainId, UrlChainPosition, ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

TRIAGE AND TUNING

Human validation before response.

WORKFLOW

1

Preserve

Retain the raw event, device or account, timestamps, and campaign-matched values.

2

Confirm

Validate field semantics and determine whether the matched object exists.

3

Enrich

Add reputation, prevalence, owner, identity, network, and adjacent-event context.

4

Scope

Search for related execution, persistence, access, and follow-on activity.

Expected benign overlap

Administration, software development, security testing, automation, content inspection, shared infrastructure, or legitimate files may overlap. Tune only after ownership and prevalence are established.

Response boundary

A URL match does not prove delivery, QR scanning, credential capture, MFA bypass, or account compromise.

VALIDATION GATES

Controlled tests and promotion criteria.

QUALITY CONTROL

Validation steps

1. Confirm the primary table and every projected field exist.
2. Replay an authorized benign event matching the query shape.
3. Measure at least 30 days of tenant prevalence and benign overlap.
4. Verify every result retains sufficient evidence for triage.

Decision criteria

Success: the test is visible and real matches remain attributable.

Rejection: benign activity dominates or the campaign artifact is no longer reliable.

Failure: required telemetry or fields are unavailable.

Promotion gate

Do not promote to production until telemetry, prevalence, ownership, and false-positive handling are demonstrated in the target environment.

CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

Hunting query

Hunts five source-published hostnames in email and QR-code-extracted URLs.

A URL match does not prove delivery, QR scanning, credential capture, MFA bypass, or account compromise.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1566.002

References

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2. Cisco Talos. "UAT-11985: AI-assisted event lures delivering real-time Google AitM phishing."
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Document control

Canonical locked typography and layout. Only the campaign illustration on page 1 is variable.